



2026 CANADIAN GRAND PRIX

22 - 24 May 2026

From	The Stewards	Document	26
To	The Team Manager, Visa Cash App Racing Bulls F1 Team	Date	22 May 2026
		Time	17:18

The Stewards, having received a report from the Race Director, have considered the following matter and determine the following:

No / Driver 30 - Liam Lawson

Competitor Visa Cash App Racing Bulls F1 Team

Time 15:00

Session Free Practice 1

Fact The CDS did not function when the car stopped on the track.

Infringement Breach of Article C9.3 of the FIA F1 Regulations.

Decision The competitor (Visa Cash App Racing Bulls F1 Team) is fined €30,000, €20,000 of which is suspended for a period of 12 months subject to no further breach of this regulation by the Competitor, for either of its cars.

Reason The Stewards heard from the driver of Car 30 (Liam Lawson), team representatives, the FIA Technical Delegate and FIA Electronics Engineer and reviewed telemetry and in-car video evidence.

The team's engineer explained how the CDS system worked. It was noted that the system on this car performs two roles – the one for which it is primarily intended, namely to release the clutch when the car is stopped and the engine is not working, and the other relates to the anti-stall system. In this case, a ruptured joint caused a hydraulic leak, which caused the car to stop. The CDS, when activated by the marshal, then failed to release the clutch and hence the car could not be moved.

This is a serious matter. It resulted in the session being red-flagged. Had the system worked as intended by the regulations, the incident could have been dealt with swiftly via deployment of the Virtual Safety Car.

The Stewards note the concern of the FIA Technical Delegate, over the dual purpose of the CDS on this car. The Technical Delegate advised that the team had, in 2025, been warned about the CDS system design for its cars.

The Driver noted that there were two issues of concern that he wished to draw to the attention of the Stewards, namely that contrary to his instructions and common practice, the marshals attempted to push the car when it was stationary, and that the marshal who attempted to activate the CDS was trying to press a button on the on-board camera rather than the CDS button. This indicates to the Stewards that further training in this area is required, notwithstanding the fact that the FIA distributes a very clear document addressing this action. (ref "FIA Single Seater Recovery Specifications"). We note that it is obvious that the distribution of such a document, although well detailed, probably needs supplementing with some form of practical training by the organisers.

Competitors are reminded that they have the right to appeal certain decisions of the Stewards, in accordance with Article 15 of the FIA International Sporting Code and Chapter 5 of the FIA Judicial and Disciplinary Rules, within the applicable time limits.

Decisions of the Stewards are taken independently of the FIA and are based solely on the relevant regulations, guidelines and evidence presented.

Garry Connelly

Tanja Geilhausen

Pedro Lamy

Marcel Demers

The Stewards